

February

2

1709

Island castaway

After being marooned alone on a deserted island for more than four years, Scottish naval officer Alexander Selkirk was finally rescued.



Born this day

1977 Shakira, Colombian singer and songwriter. She has received hundreds of music awards for her memorable pop songs and unique Latin American style.

1925

Heroic huskies

Teams of husky dogs travelled more than 1,000 km (620 miles) across winter snow to the remote Alaskan town of Nome in the USA. They were carrying life-saving diphtheria serum, which prevented an outbreak of the deadly disease.



Also on this day

1887 Groundhog Day got underway in Pennsylvania, USA, when a groundhog named Punxsutawney Phil was first given the job of “predicting” a longer winter or an early spring.

1943 The Battle of Stalingrad, the bloodiest battle of World War II, ended in Soviet victory.

2004 Swiss tennis ace Roger Federer took the world number one ranking and maintained it for a record-breaking 237 weeks.



1912

Spectacular stunt

US daredevil Frederick Rodman Law performed the first stunt for a film when he parachuted from the torch of the Statue of Liberty in New York Harbor, USA.